

New Project Analysis

Client/Project	
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Date	
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CLIENT

Client's Business Health

- ☐ Struggling to be profitable
- ☐ Making ends meet
- ☐ Very successful business

Personal Relationship

- ☐ We've never worked together
- ☐ Referred to us
- ☐ Many successful projects together

Past Experience with Agencies

- ☐ Negative experience
- ☐ Minimal experience
- ☐ Robust experience

Perception of Us

- ☐ Production monkeys
- ☐ Necessary but expendable
- ☐ Expert in the room

Future Opportunities

- ☐ Single project, no chance more work
- ☐ Possible future projects
- ☐ Tons of potential for more work

Network

- ☐ Not many contacts
- ☐ Decent network
- ☐ Many influential relationships

Technical Knowledge

- ☐ Behind the times
- ☐ Functional with basics
- ☐ Very tech savvy

Communication

- ☐ Incoherent babble
- ☐ Good enough
- ☐ Clear, organized, and timely

Notoriety

- ☐ Don't tell anyone they're a client
- ☐ Not embarrassed but not proud either
- ☐ They'd be in our top five clients

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PROJECT

Expertise Alignment

- ☐ We've never done a project like this
- ☐ We can figure it out
- ☐ Perfect fit for our agency

Production Knowledge

- ☐ Client doesn't understand production flow
- ☐ Some related past experience
- ☐ Tons of experience with similar projects

Deadline

- ☐ Nights and weekends required
- ☐ Reasonable timeline
- ☐ Plenty of time to do it right

Decision Maker Access

- ☐ No access to decision maker
- ☐ Some occasional access
- ☐ Working directly with decision maker

Competition

- ☐ Open RFP, heavy competition
- ☐ Moderate competition
- ☐ We are the agency of choice

Risk Factor

- ☐ If we fail, their business fails
- ☐ No major risks to their business
- ☐ If we fail, their business will be fine

Portfolio Opportunity

- ☐ We would never show the work
- ☐ Possible portfolio piece
- ☐ Could be an award winner

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PRICE

Profit Potential

- ☐ Tight budget, we may lose money
- ☐ Enough profit to be worth it
- ☐ Cha-ching! Mega profit!

Fair Market Value

- ☐ Budget is lower than market value
- ☐ Industry average budget
- ☐ Budget is better than industry

Payment Terms

- ☐ Client wants to delay first payment
- ☐ Comfortable with payment terms
- ☐ Happy to pay upon receipt of invoice

Money Source

- ☐ Funded by personal cash or debt
- ☐ Funded by external debt
- ☐ Well funded, successful business

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The objective of this worksheet is to help you systematically analyze a project opportunity. The perfect project will have many green results and few reds in all three categories: client, project, and price.

Although an opportunity may have some red results, it does not mean that you shouldn't take on the project. Identifying the red flags will help you know potential pitfalls and be better equipped to anticipate and counteract them.

Select a response for each category and consider your answers carefully before embarking on your next project opportunity.

